Making academic expectations explicit

Are terminology and expectations explicit?

LANGUAGE / CURRICULUM

ONE-PAGE TEACHING GUIDE

WHAT IS IT?

Transparent expectations on terminology and outcomes replace hidden norms

WHY DOES IT MATTER?

University contains many hidden rules: what “critical analysis” means, what a rubric is really asking for, when it is acceptable to ask for help, or what counts as “professional” behaviour. If those rules remain unspoken, familiarity can be mistaken for capability.

THE STUDENT EXPERIENCE

- “Everyone else seems to know rules nobody has explained.”
- “I understand the topic, but not what I am being asked to do.”

HOW CAN I DO IT?

- Name what key terms mean in the discipline and why they matter.
- Explain what quality looks like before assessment, not only after it.
- Replace vague expectations with examples and plain explanations.

EXAMPLE IN PRACTICE

The course profile defines terms like “critical reflection” and “professional communication” using short examples.

STARTING POINT TO ADAPT

This course has been designed to make academic terminology, processes and expectations explicit. If you notice an avoidable barrier or an important perspective that is missing, tell us through [contact/channel] so the…

GO FURTHER AT UQ

View the Influential Communicators example

Inclusive practice

Digital Essentials